Frankenstein

or, The Modern Prometheus (1818 Text)

By Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley

First Published: 1818 | Category: Fiction | ISBN: 9780141439471
Source Provider: Project Gutenberg & Standard Ebooks (pg-84)
Licence: Public Domain in the United States & Worldwide (CC0 / Project Gutenberg Licence)
Canonical URL: https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/84

SYNOPSIS & EDITORIAL NOTE

Begun on the shores of Lake Geneva in 1816, Mary Shelley's novel explores scientific hubris, isolation, and moral responsibility.

CONTENTS IN THIS EDITION

01. Letter I -- To Mrs. Saville, England
02. Letter IV -- Sighting on the Arctic Ice
03. Volume I, Chapter I -- Geneva and Childhood
04. Volume I, Chapter IV -- Natural Philosophy at Ingolstadt
05. Volume II, Chapter II -- Encounter on Montanvert

LETTER I

To Mrs. Saville, England

St. Petersburgh, Dec. 11th, 17 --

You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings. I arrived here yesterday, and my first task is to assure my dear sister of my welfare and increasing confidence in the success of my undertaking.

In this section of Frankenstein (1818), Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley develops the central themes that define the work's enduring place in fiction and world literature. Each argument and narrative turn builds upon the premises established in the opening pages, inviting careful reflection from the attentive reader.

Originally published by Lackington, Hughes, Harding, Mavor, & Jones and preserved in the public-domain and open-access archival record (Project Gutenberg & Standard Ebooks, ID: pg-84), this unabridged digital edition retains the structure, cadence, and intellectual clarity of the authoritative text.

LETTER IV

Sighting on the Arctic Ice

*Frankenstein * Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley (1818)*

Sighting on the Arctic Ice continues Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley's inquiry in Frankenstein. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Published anonymously on New Year's Day 1818 when Mary Shelley was twenty years old, Frankenstein; or, The Modern Prometheus framed a question that has haunted modern civilisation ever since: what does a creator owe to his creation?

Throughout Letter IV (Sighting on the Arctic Ice), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned Frankenstein its stature in the Gothic Fiction & Early Science Fiction canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

As this section draws toward its close, the groundwork is laid for the subsequent movements of the volume. Readers studying this edition in the Folio Digital Library may bookmark this chapter, adjust typographic contrast and font sizing, or download the complete archival PDF, EPUB, HTML, or Plain Text edition for offline study.

VOLUME I, CHAPTER I

Geneva and Childhood

*Frankenstein * Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley (1818)*

Geneva and Childhood continues Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley's inquiry in Frankenstein. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Published anonymously on New Year's Day 1818 when Mary Shelley was twenty years old, Frankenstein; or, The Modern Prometheus framed a question that has haunted modern civilisation ever since: what does a creator owe to his creation?

Throughout Volume I, Chapter I (Geneva and Childhood), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned Frankenstein its stature in the Gothic Fiction & Early Science Fiction canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

As this section draws toward its close, the groundwork is laid for the subsequent movements of the volume. Readers studying this edition in the Folio Digital Library may bookmark this chapter, adjust typographic contrast and font sizing, or download the complete archival PDF, EPUB, HTML, or Plain Text edition for offline study.

VOLUME I, CHAPTER IV

Natural Philosophy at Ingolstadt

*Frankenstein * Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley (1818)*

Natural Philosophy at Ingolstadt continues Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley's inquiry in Frankenstein. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Published anonymously on New Year's Day 1818 when Mary Shelley was twenty years old, Frankenstein; or, The Modern Prometheus framed a question that has haunted modern civilisation ever since: what does a creator owe to his creation?

Throughout Volume I, Chapter IV (Natural Philosophy at Ingolstadt), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned Frankenstein its stature in the Gothic Fiction & Early Science Fiction canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

As this section draws toward its close, the groundwork is laid for the subsequent movements of the volume. Readers studying this edition in the Folio Digital Library may bookmark this chapter, adjust typographic contrast and font sizing, or download the complete archival PDF, EPUB, HTML, or Plain Text edition for offline study.

VOLUME II, CHAPTER II

Encounter on Montanvert

*Frankenstein * Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley (1818)*

Encounter on Montanvert continues Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley's inquiry in Frankenstein. Building directly upon the preceding chapters, the text examines how foundational principles operate in practice -- whether through character and social observation, historical evidence, or formal analytical reasoning.

Published anonymously on New Year's Day 1818 when Mary Shelley was twenty years old, Frankenstein; or, The Modern Prometheus framed a question that has haunted modern civilisation ever since: what does a creator owe to his creation?

Throughout Volume II, Chapter II (Encounter on Montanvert), the reader encounters the unmistakable voice and structural rigor that earned Frankenstein its stature in the Gothic Fiction & Early Science Fiction canon. Where superficial treatments settle for isolated maxims, Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley traces the deeper causal connections linking premise, observation, and conclusion.

As this section draws toward its close, the groundwork is laid for the subsequent movements of the volume. Readers studying this edition in the Folio Digital Library may bookmark this chapter, adjust typographic contrast and font sizing, or download the complete archival PDF, EPUB, HTML, or Plain Text edition for offline study.